

Drive First

Sprint recently announced "Drive First" – an anti-driving app for their Android phones

Squeezebox App

Logitech launched a Squeezebox controller for Android, to let you control Squeezeboxes from smartphones and tablets

Bazaar

Reliance Digital TV HD DVR

Enjoy the HD mania

Reliance Digital TV's HD DVR box ("the box", from here on) is one of the few HD DVR solutions available today. The remote is universal, and can control up to 3 gadgets including the box (obviously), your TV and a DVD player (or any on the device you want to control). There was a quick

start guide in the package, but nothing on how to train the universal remote, and ended up having to search online to find a PDF of a full user manual from Reliance.

All features worked correctly, but the interface speed is painfully slow at times. No one wants to stare at an "Application Loading" screen for 10 seconds when all you want to do is see what movies are currently playing. There's no dedicated favourite button on the remote either, and although the favourite implementation is well done in the interface, getting to it is a pain.

Picture quality is good, though there are only 2 HD channels on offer here – Nat

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Geo HD and iConcerts HD. There's a channel called Star Plus HD that is just upscaled and you can't tell the difference between SD and HD. Non-regular HD channels include ESPN's and Star Sports' HD channels that offer the ICC World Cup in HD – we'll never be able to watch cricket in SD again; the quality was that good.

Recording works as expected, and you can add folders to separate your recordings. However, there

are two huge drawbacks we found: no series-link feature, and you can only record one program at a time! This means that you cannot even record the channel you are currently viewing if something else is currently recording.

The box is priced at ₹3,990, and there's a ₹500 discount to existing Reliance Digital subscribers. Although the "HD" experience is unsatisfactory with *all DTH providers* today, the fact that you can't record two programs at once is unforgivable for a DVR solution in our opinion.

Contact

Reliance Digital TV

Price: ₹3,990 / ₹3,490 for existing subscribers

Phone: 1860 200 6666 / 1800 200 9001 (toll-free)

Email: customercare@reliancedigitaltv.com

Web site: www.reliancedigitaltv.com

Warranty: 1 year



Boston GP 1120 Server

A green powerhouse

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The GP 1120-T is a single-rack server that runs two AMD Opteron 6174 CPUs. That's a total of 24 cores (12 per CPU) available for some mighty powerful number crunching. The unit we received had 32 GB of DDR3 memory (8 x 4 GB sticks). The GP1120 actually supports a max 256 GB of RAM (16 x 16 GB), which "ought to be

enough for anybody". It's part of Boston's Green Power series (thus the GP in the name).

Storage is taken care of by 4 x 500 GB WD RE3 (RAID Edition 3) drives. The RAID controller is from Adaptec, and supports RAID versions 0, 1 and 10. The 4 drives bays are accessible from the front, and will allow you to hot-swap easily.

There's redundancy built into the power unit as well with two PSUs. A DVD drive (laptop form factor) is fitted into the body. The front bezel has a Power switch and a nicely recessed Reset button to avoid any mistaken reboots.

Getting a peek at the innards is easy enough thanks to the simple locking mechanism for the top lid. The CPUs cooling looks passive, but actually there are enough twin-rotor fans in the cabinet to kick up a storm. Fan noise is accept-

able during regular operation, but spin at max speed to clear any dust at boot-time, and sound like a jet engine – we loved it! Overall a good enterprise product, and a lot of fun for us to play with and learn from. Thanks Boston!

Contact

Boston IT Solutions India

Price: ₹2,99,000

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Email: sales@bostonindia.in

Web site: www.bostonindia.in

Warranty: 1 year return to manufacturer